Charles S. Argon

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RESEARCH AREAS

China since 1500; History of Empire; Digital Humanities

EMPLOYMENT

Assistant Professor, Institute of Qing History, Renmin University of China 2026-
Junior Faculty Talent Program

EDUCATION

Ph.D. Princeton University, History 2026
Dissertation: "*Baojia*: A Policy for Household Registration and Community Policing in Qing China, c. 1723-1839"
Committee: He Bian (adviser), Janet Chen, Sheldon Garon, Sean Wilentz, Taisu Zhang
General Examinations passed with distinction

M.A. Tsinghua University, Chinese History 2021

B.A. Princeton University, East Asian Studies, *summa cum laude* 2017

Visiting Student, Tsinghua University 2024-2025
Visiting Researcher, University of Tokyo July 2023
Visiting Student, Zhejiang University 2017-2018
Exchange Student, Tsinghua University Fall 2015

BOOK PROJECT

(Manuscript in preparation, based on dissertation) *Community Policing in Early Modern China.*

PEER-REVIEWED ARTICLES

"Dai Zhaochen Learns to be an Official: Statecraft Ideas and Local Governance in Late Qing China." *Journal of Chinese History* (2025): 1-22.

"*The Problem of China*: Orientalism, 'Young China', and Russell's Western Audience." *Russell: The Journal of Bertrand Russell Studies* 35, no. 2 (2015): 154-176.

OTHER PUBLICATIONS

"On Path to Multimodal Historical Reasoning: HistBench and HistAgent." *ArXiv Preprint* 2505.20246. One of numerous coauthors.

《清高宗远征缅甸中的调马理路——以"马力"为中心》("Horse Provisioning for Qianlong's War in Burma: with a focus on 'horsepower'"). 《华大史学论坛》 (*Proceedings of the Central China Normal University History Forum*) 8 (2021):104-120.

TEACHING

Teaching Assistant, "The United States Since 1974," Princeton University — Spring 2024

Freelance High School History Instructor — 2018-2026

- Courses: "Unlocking History's Secrets" (5 semesters); "American History: A Thematic Approach" (3 semesters); "AP World History" (3 semesters); "The Golden Age of Plague"
- Independent Projects (selected): "Local Order in Seventeenth Century China: *Voices from the Cataclysm*"; "New Identity: the Xiang Army's Reconstruction Project in Xinjiang…"

Princeton University Writing Center Fellow — 2015-2017

Princeton University Petey Greene Tutor — 2015-2017

HONORS AND FELLOWSHIPS

Huo Family Fellowship, Princeton University — 2024-2025

William A. Dippel '50 *55 Graduate Fellowship, Princeton University — 2022-2023

Chinese Government Scholarship, Tsinghua University — 2019-2021

2nd Prize, Central China Normal University History Forum — 2021

Fulbright Fellowship to China — 2017-2018

Marjory Chadwick Buchanan Senior Thesis Prize, East Asian Studies — 2017

Phi Beta Kappa, Princeton University — 2017

INVITED TALKS

"Qing zhongqi baojia 'shixing' pouxi: yi Jiangxi sheng hukou shuju wei xiansuo" ("'Really Doing' Baojia in the Mid-Qing Period: A Study of Jiangxi's Hukou Data"). Professor A Feng Research Group, Tsinghua University, June 5, 2025.

"Jinqi beimei qingshi yanjiu" ("Recent North American Scholarship on Qing History.") *Professor Qi Xuemin Research Group*, Tsinghua University, December 16, 2024.

"Zuowei zhengzhi yundong de qingdai baojia zhi: yi qianlong chao de Jiangxi sheng wei li" ("The Qing Baojia System as a Political Movement: The Case of Jiangxi Province in the Qianlong Reign"). *Professor Zhao Siyuan Research Group*, Shanghai Jiaotong University, December 10, 2024.

ORGANIZED PANELS

"The Ghosts of Wittfogel: Recategorizing Early Modern Systems of Neighborhood Governance." *American Historical Association*, January 8, 2026. Co-organized roundtable on "Comparing Ideas About Political Economy in the Ottoman and Qing Empires: A Discussion of Sources and Methods."

"Li Yanzhang's Baojia Policy in Late Qing Guangxi." *Association for Asian Studies*, Cincinnati. March 15, 2025. Panel Organizer for "Translating Qing Political Categories onto New Frontiers: From Inner Asia to the Outer Seas."

"Ideology and Mobilization in the Tongzhi Reign: The Political Vision of Dai Zhaochen 戴肇辰." *AAS (Association for Asian Studies) New England Regional Conference*, Wellesley College, October 14, 2023. Co-organized and co-chaired panel on "Ways of Knowing: Excavating Concepts in Qing Intellectual History."

OTHER PRESENTATIONS

Argon, Charles. "Qianlong-Era Population Reports Revisited: Census-Taking in Global Historical Perspective" [乾隆时期民数奏报再谈——全球史视野下的人口统计]. Paper presented (online) at the International Conference on the Development of Qing History and the Centenary of Dai Yi's Birth (国际清史学科发展暨戴逸先生百岁诞辰纪念大会), Renmin University of China, Beijing, September 6, 2026.

"Baojia's Mutual Responsibility Provisions in Qing Legal Practice: Evidence from Legal Cases." *International Society for Chinese Law & History Conference*, July 22-23, 2025.

"The Flow of Policy Information in Late Qing China: The 1813 Baojia Reforms in Practice." *Involution and Revolution: Information in Nineteenth Century China*, Peking University, June 14-15, 2025.

"The Qing Dynasty Baojia System in World History, c. 1680-1780." *World History Association Conference*, San Francisco State University, June 28, 2024.

"Policy Drift: The spread of collective responsibility (*baojia)* in China, c. 1723-1768." *Regulatory Governance in a Changing World Conference*, University of Pennsylvania Law School, June 18, 2024.

"Mourning in the Qing Bureaucracy: Bureaucratic Influence, Political Participation, and the Archive." *Mid-Atlantic Region Association for Asian Studies Conference*, University of Pennsylvania, October 1, 2022.

"The Rhythms of Commodification: Mid-Qing Military Horse Provisioning," *AAS (Association for Asian Studies) New England Regional Conference*, Harvard University, December 6, 2021.

"The Rhythms of Commodification: Mid-Qing Military Horse Provisioning," *Mid-Atlantic Region Association for Asian Studies Conference*, Villanova University, October 24, 2021.

"Qing gaozong yuanzheng miandian zhong de diaoma lilu —— yi 'mali' wei zhongxin" ("Cherishing Horsepower: Horse Requisitioning in the Qing-Burma War, 1765-1770"), *Central China Normal University Chinese History Graduate Student Forum (online)*, Wuhan University, November 8, 2020.

"Ningbo kaibu tongshang hou shi nianjian de fubai yu shehui maodun: yi difang guan duice he siwei wei zhongxin de kaocha" ("Corruption and Social Conflict in Ningbo: An Inquiry into the Policies of Local Officials, 1843-1853"), *Zhejiang Studies Forum*, Ningbo University, October 20, 2018.

OTHER EXPERIENCE

Research Assistant, Janet Chen: *The Search for Modern China, 4th edition*	2021-2023
Research Assistant, Linda Colley: *The Gun, The Ship, and the Pen*	2017

PROFESSIONAL SERVICE AND ACTIVITY

Cohort Representative, History Graduate Association, Princeton University	2024-2026
Co-organizer, AI and History Working Group, Princeton	Spring 2025
Co-organizer, Global History Workshop, Princeton	2022-2023
Organizer, Political Economy Reading Group, Tsinghua	2020-2021
Organizer, Manchu Documents Workshop, Tsinghua	Jan. 2020

LANGUAGES

Native: English; Fluent: Mandarin; reading: Japanese, Classical Chinese, French, Manchu